

If you haven't already applied for a credit card, stop right here. I sense you're one of those vanilla lurkers who reads blog post after another while dreaming how awesome life can be. This book is written especially for people like you with specific *how-to-do's* and that means you drop the smile on your face, open that expensive laptop and crunch a few tabs of Bankbazaar's credit card offerings. After you've applied for the credit card of your choice, get back in here as we're going to talk some serious adult stuff.

Adult Business (full attention)

In my short sojourn, I've believed in two things when it comes to personal finance:

- 1) Never go into debt for something that will depreciate (vacations, electronics, car etc.)
- 2) Pre-plan and allocate cash-flow to run on auto mode.

When it comes to thumb rules, personal finance authors write down several opinions. Beyond the above two, there's just one more after which I promise I'll tap out. You will roll your eyes when reading this because you might have heard it a million times but ***pay-yourself-first*** is a great concept. To the uninitiated, '*pay-yourself-first*' means you identify which big goals (retirement, child's college, a home etc.) you'd like to achieve in the future and invest toward them. The difference is: you invest towards it immediately after the salary hits your bank account.

Once you do this, the balance in your salary account remains for current expenses. From the previous week, we realized that living sexy now and funding the big-goals in the future are equally important. Hence, we will establish a cash flow that prioritizes both the present and the future with equal importance. The way to do this is inculcate a 'Conscious Spending' ^[13] plan.

CSP is about having a mental map of your money allocation like Sherlock Holmes. This way, you know you're not forfeiting the future by